

The Dhāraṇī Called the Noble Great Illusion, Bestower of Total Victory, Requested by the Son of Craving-Free

Nārāyaṇapaipṛcchvā Āryamahāmāyāvijayavāhinī nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 684 · Derge Kangyur
སདྲི་མདེ་ཀུན་གྱི་ཐུ་ཞུ་པ་འཕགས་པ་སྐྱུ་ཆེ་མོ་རྣམ་པར་རྒྱ་བ་ཐོབ་པར་བདེ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའཁོམ་ཅུ་སྟེ།

Toh 684 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Nārāyaṇapaipṛcchvā Āryamahāmāyāvijayavāhinī and in Tibetan as the Srid med kyi bus zhus pa 'phags pa sgyu ma chen mo rnam par rgyal ba thob par byed pa, rendered into English as the Noble Great Illusion, Bestower of Total Victory, Requested by the Son of Craving-Free. It belongs to the dhāraṇī category of Buddhist canonical literature, which gathers sacred formulas believed to carry protective and transformative power. The text is framed as a discourse given by the Buddha at the summit of a mountain called Golden Horn, in the mansion of the deity Vaiśravaṇa, and centers on a son of an asura king who, having been defeated in battle and stripped of his glory, seeks the Buddha's aid — providing the occasion for the revelation of this powerful dhāraṇī. As Toh 684 in the Kangyur, it belongs to the broader collection of translated Indian Buddhist scriptures preserved in the Tibetan Buddhist canon.

In the language of India: Nārāyaṇapaipṛcchvā Āryamahāmāyāvijayavāhinī nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: the dhāraṇī called the Noble Great Illusion, Bestower of Total Victory, requested by the Son of Craving-Free.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at the summit of a mountain called Golden Horn, in the mansion of Vaiśravaṇa, enumerating the collection of teachings called the Gateway of the Arising of the Dharma, praised by the many: gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great serpents, vidyādhara, and water-born goddesses, and the rest.

Then the son of the asura king — defeated in battle, diminished in all his power, fallen in every glory, his majestic force weakened — came into the presence of the Blessed One. Having come before him, he touched his forehead to the Blessed One's two feet in prostration and sat to one side. Seated to one side, he then made this supplication:

"O Blessed One — omniscient, all-seeing, full of loving concern for all sentient beings — please teach that collection of teachings by which gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, and the rest, or indeed human beings, when weapons are falling in the midst of battle, or in the struggle for livelihood, or in any dispute whatsoever, shall in every respect be completely victorious."

The Blessed One declared: "You who wield illusion, son of Craving-Free — you who are endowed with great illusion, who possess tremendous power and deceive sentient beings with your manifold tricks — why is it that you come here seized with fear, asking and inquiring so insistently about how to be victorious in battle?"

The Son of Craving-Free spoke: "Blessed One, the king of the asuras of the desire realm has here defeated me through the guile of the asuras; some of the gods have died, some have been overcome, and some have been crushed. Blessed One, please teach that collection of teachings by which sentient beings shall be made completely victorious in battle, by which the asuras shall be vanquished, and by which the pride of the asuras shall be ground down."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of Craving-Free, long ago in the past there arose on the mountain Magaṇdhāroḥita a king called Ratnabhūṣaṇa. At that time and in that age there appeared a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly complete buddha — endowed with knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, a knower of the world, unsurpassed, a tamer of persons to be tamed, a teacher of gods and humans — a Blessed One, a buddha, known as Sarvaiśvara, Lord of All. From the presence of that Blessed One Sarvaiśvara, I properly memorised, retained, recited, fully penetrated, rejoiced in, and then extensively and correctly taught to others these words of the vidyā-mantra called the Great Illusion, Bestower of Total Victory.

Son of Craving-Free, by the power of this dhāraṇī, free at all times from the fear of enemies, the fear of adversity, and the fear of thieves, he ruled his kingdom in accordance with the Dharma for one hundred thousand years. And thereafter, by the power of the dhāraṇī, he moved freely through cities, other towns, and pleasure gardens as if moving through a spectacle. When he was reborn he became the bodhisattva known as Māṅghāha, a wheel-turning king in full possession of the seven precious royal treasures.

His command extended over all three worlds. Because the perfection of generosity he had formerly practiced remained undiminished, he worked for the benefit of all sentient beings in whatever way they desired, showering

down a stream of wealth upon those of fortunate and excellent circumstance, bringing happiness to all sentient beings, and working benefit for all. Son of Craving-Free, in this way, through the power of this dhāraṇī, he brought the accumulation of the perfection of generosity to complete fulfillment over the course of many hundreds of cosmic ages. Moreover, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, great serpents, vidyādharas, humans, and non-humans all abided in accordance with his command, and none of them turned away from it. Having thus advanced through sixty-four thousand cosmic ages, thereafter, in a single rebirth, just as a lord of nāgas who has been liberated from the fear of garuḍas abides in perfect peace, he became, in this world, an unsurpassed, fully and perfectly awakened buddha — an unexcelled arhat, a teacher even to the gods.

Son of Craving-Free, therefore, you should take up and hold these words of the vidyā-mantra called the Great Illusion, Bestower of Total Victory. Tadyathā: namastryanghānugatapratiśthitebhyaḥ sarvābuddhābodhisatṭebhyaḥ sarvamudrāmantrapādebhyaḥ oṃ māye mahāmālāngāraṇi iyaṃ sā mahāmāyāmantenā mahāmālārāpeṇa bhrama bhrama ma sarvasatvānañcayebirūnghakaṇ cintasarvadushtasatvāstāntrā maya maya mohaya mohaya mūrccāpaya mūrccāvaya mārata māraya viñtāṃsaya viñtāṃsaya mara mara mahāmāye alalalālā mahāmāyājāla sahasramukhis sahasraśīres sahasraghujevalitanetra sarvatathāgatahṛdayagarbhe asiṅghanuḥ paraśubhāśatoma rakaṇaya śaktimubhūḍihaste muṅgārakahaste ehyehi bhagavati sarvatathāgatasatyena devarṣigaṇasatyena mahāmālavijayābāhini smara smara sarvatathāgatajñānarūpeṇa gaccha gaccha sarvāvaraṇakṣayaṃ karīvarasinyabidrāvaṇi mohala mohaya maṃ ma sarvasatvānābhañca sarvadushtārṣa rakṣa rakṣa māṃ sarvasatvāñca sarvabhayobadravebhyaḥ svāhā. Oṃ mahāmāyāngāraṇiye svāhā. Oṃ mahīmaṇḍalānghisthānānghisthite svāhā. Oṃ vajrangārabanditapūjitāyai svāhā. Oṃ padmayānibhriyāya svāhā. Oṃ sarvadevanamaskṛte svāhā. Oṃ mātṛgaṇabanditapūjitāyai svāhā. Oṃ jaye svāhā. Oṃ jaye svāhā. Oṃ vijaye svāhā. Oṃ svāhā. Oṃ abhighite svāhā. Oṃ aparājite svāhā. Oṃ mohanīya svāhā. Oṃ stambhanāye svāhā. Oṃ jambhāniye svāhā. Oṃ jayantiye svāhā. Oṃ bhamaṇiye svāhā. Oṃ bhramaṇiye svāhā. Oṃ sarvāsuraḍamanīye svāhā. Oṃ mahākālābanditapūjitāyai svāhā. Oṃ kāmārūpiṇiye svāhā. Oṃ māyārākṣasiye svāhā. Oṃ rara svāhā. Oṃ rūrū hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ hejaye māyābhagavatī mahāmāyāvijayabāhini gṛhṇa śīghramā bilāmā svamama

sarvasatvānāñca sarvakāryaṃ kuru kuru hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā.

Son of Craving-Free, in this way, take up, recite, and teach extensively and correctly to others these words of the secret mantra of the dhāraṇī called the Great Illusion, Bestower of Total Victory. Son of Craving-Free,

Then, at the time of that battle, during the interval between the two armies, in the five positions one should apply wheels of this dhāraṇī fashioned in the shape of a chariot. Son of Craving-Free, at that time, in the midst between both sides, one should visualize above the head of the opposing army, at the center of that chariot, the queen of knowledge-mantras called the Great Illusion, Bestower of Total Victory — possessing forms and arms numbering many hundreds of thousands, with three eyes, her four faces blazing red-black, devouring the opposing army. Imagining oneself as a wheel-turning monarch, one writes the dhāraṇī on a parasol using saffron, and this utterly conceals both the king's own army and the opposing army beneath a single nature, as if an illusion, while through many heart-essences one becomes victorious as a king. Son of Craving-Free, the forces of the opposing army are defeated and routed; some, it is said, collapse and fall to the ground. Son of Craving-Free, even this falling is to be judged by the penalty of the path of the ten non-virtues — it does not carry the result of cutting off their lives. Son of Craving-Free, such is the power of this dhāraṇī worthy of praise.

Son of Craving-Free, furthermore, whoever recites these words of the dhāraṇī mantra three times each day — whether having purified themselves or not, whether having fasted or not — even one who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution (ānantarya) will, having exhausted that mass of evil, obtain a mass of merit and will come to remember their past lives. They will enjoy a wealth that pervades all sentient beings and will delight in virtuous dharmas; but this is not so for those who have fallen into non-virtue and wrong views. Son of Craving-Free, furthermore, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family, monk or nun, layman or laywoman, king or prince or brahmin, who upholds this dhāraṇī — at the time of their death, they will abide in the light of the sacred Dharma; and whoever among men or women touches even their ashes or cremated remains will assuredly come to remember their past lives.

Then Son of Craving-Free, marveling with the exclamation "How wonderful!" at the bodhisattva vow, set down his conch shell, wheel, staff, and flower garlands, rose from his seat, circumambulated the Blessed One three times,

paid homage, and with a smiling countenance praised the Blessed One in melodious verse:

How wondrous! Among gods and asuras and the world,
you are the supreme lord, the highest, without peer.
Resting well in peace, having grasped what is excellent,
to you who have transcended the world I bow and offer praise.

You reveal perfectly the arising of all phenomena
as being without inherent existence.

Freed from dharma and what is not dharma —
to you, the true Dharma, I bow and offer praise.

Then Son of Craving-Free bowed down to the Blessed One, said, "Blessed One, I take my own affairs upon myself," and departed.

Upon hearing what the Blessed One had taught, the entire assembly — gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras, garuḍas (sky-soaring ones), kinnaras (half-human beings), great serpents, knowledge-holders, water-born goddesses, and all the rest — together with the world of gods, humans, asuras, garuḍas, and gandharvas, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

This concludes the noble dhāraṇī called the Great Illusion, Bestower of Total Victory, requested by Son of Craving-Free.

This is a supremely noble dispeller of false views, based on the history of the dhāraṇī vidyā that was not previously known to have been translated into Tibetan. In the material year of the thirteenth rabjung cycle, the venerable lama, the glorious Vidyādhara, having received through relay messenger the authoritative command to seek out a Sanskrit manuscript from the land of Nepal and translate it, did so on an auspicious waxing day of the winter month of that year, at the glorious Palpung Monastery of the Dege domain in Lower Amdo.

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit title in the opening line is in Siddham-style transcription as found in canonical Tibetan texts; the Tibetan title given is its translation. The rendering "Son of Craving-Free" for Sred med kyi bu reflects the standard Tibetan designation for Nārāyaṇa (lit. "son of Nārā/the craving-free one"), functioning here as a proper name for an asura prince rather than as a doctrinal term.

The mountain name Magaṇdhāroḥita and the buddha name Sarvaiśvara are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic renderings Ma ga ndhā ro hi ta and Thams cad dbang phyug; the exact Sanskrit originals may vary across witnesses.

The term rigs pa 'dzin pa, rendered here as "vidyādharas" (holders of knowledge-spells), could also be rendered "mantra-holders" or "knowledge-bearers"; the doctrinal referent is the same class of beings.

- The mantra passage is transliterated directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit, following standard practice for dhāraṇī texts. Individual syllables in the mantra body may not correspond perfectly to recoverable Sanskrit originals, as is common in Tibetan canonical transmission of such texts; no attempt has been made to normalize or emend the mantra syllables beyond faithful transliteration.
- The phrase rendered "water-born goddesses" translates རྒྱལ་ལྷ་མོ་མཚན་མོ་, literally "water-born females," which likely refers to a class of aquatic or lotus-born divine beings; the exact Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain in this context.

The line 吾人各取吾人各事 is idiomatic and elliptical; the translation "I take my own affairs upon myself" conveys the sense of taking personal responsibility or leave-taking, though the precise nuance may be a formal expression of departure or self-sufficiency.

- The colophon is fragmentary, breaking off mid-sentence at "Palpung Monastery." The passage is a standard Tibetan colophon identifying: the rabjung cycle date (the thirteenth rabjung, each cycle being sixty years, placing this approximately in the nineteenth century); the translator as a lama bearing the title Vidyādhara (Rigdzin); the source as a Sanskrit exemplar obtained from Nepal; and the place of translation as Palpung Monastery in the Dege region. The phrase rendered "material year" (ལྷན་ལོ་འདི་ལོ་) refers to the first of the two years within the Tibetan calendrical reckoning sometimes called the "real" or "actual" year of the cycle, as distinct from an intercalary year — though this distinction is minor and not doctrinally significant. "Lower Amdo" for ལྷན་ལོ་འདི་ལོ་ is a slight liberty; the region more precisely designated is Kham/Dege, and ལྷན་ལོ་འདི་ལོ་ here may function as a broader regional designation; the note is included given the geographic specificity involved.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.